THIRD JOHN

Conversational Version

Salutation

[1]The Elder to Gaius, that I truly love.

[2]I pray that you'll be as prosperous and healthy in every way as you are in your soul. [3]I was so happy when the brothers reported that you really live by the truth. [4]Nothing makes me happier than hearing that my children are doing that. **3 Jn 1-4**

Cooperation and Opposition

[5]Friend[sg], you're acting faithfully in what you do for your fellow believers in Christ[Messiah], especially for the ones you don't know. [6]In front of the church, they've testified to your love. You do well to send them forward in a way worthy of God. [7]They went out for The Name, not taking anything from Gentiles. [8]We should support servants like them and so become their true fellow workers. **3 Jn 5-8**

[9]I wrote to the church, but Diotrephes, who loves to take charge among them, wouldn't receive us. [10]So if I come, I'll remind people how he slanders us, and—more than that—doesn't receive disciples, stops the ones that want to, and excommunicates them from the church. **3 Jn 9-10**

[11]Imitate good, not evil. Whoever does what's good belongs to God; whoever does what's evil hasn't seen him. [12]Demetrius receives good testimony from everybody, from the truth itself, and from us. You know you can rely on what we say. **3 Jn 11-12**

Farewell

[13]I've had so much I want to tell you[sg] but not in writing. [14]I hope to see you soon and speak to you in person. Peace to you. Your friends send their greetings. Greet your friends by name. **3 Jn 13-14**

Translator: Virgil Warren, christir.org